FENOFIBRATE

Take with food

Myopathy with statins

CHEMICAL NAME Propan-2-yl 2-{4-[(4-chlorophenyl)carbonyl]phenoxy}-2-methylpropanoate
CLASS Fibrate (PPAR-α agonist) lipid-lowering drug
TRADE NAMES Lipanthyl · Tricor · Lipidil · Fenogal

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Severe hypertriglyceridaemia (reduce pancreatitis risk).
- Mixed dyslipidaemia when statins not tolerated or as add-on (high TG, low HDL).
- Diabetic retinopathy progression (adjunct, some countries).

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** once daily with a meal (standard forms; micronised forms vary).
- Doses differ between formulations — not interchangeable mg-for-mg.

DOSAGES

- **Micronised:** 200 mg once daily (or 67 mg up to three times daily).
- **Nanoparticle/supra-bioavailable:** 145–160 mg once daily.
- **Renal impairment:** reduce dose; avoid if eGFR <30.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Peak:** 4–6 h. Prodrug hydrolysed to active fenofibric acid.
- Highly protein-bound.
- Excreted in urine. **t½:** 20 h.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Activates **PPAR-α** → ↑ lipoprotein lipase activity, ↓ apoC-III → ↓ triglycerides (up to 50%).
- ↑ HDL; modest ↓ LDL; ↓ uric acid.

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- GI upset, abdominal pain.
- Headache, rash.
- Raised transaminases.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Myopathy/rhabdomyolysis (↑ with statins, renal impairment).
- Cholelithiasis (gallstones).
- Raised creatinine (reversible).
- Pancreatitis, VTE (rare).

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Severe renal impairment; hepatic disease, gallbladder disease.
- Known photoallergy to fibrates or ketoprofen.
- Chronic or acute pancreatitis (except due to severe hypertriglyceridaemia).
- Pregnancy, breastfeeding.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Statins:** ↑ myopathy (lower risk than gemfibrozil).
- **Warfarin:** ↑ INR; reduce warfarin dose.
- **Ciclosporin:** nephrotoxicity.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Baseline and regular lipids, LFTs, creatinine.
- Ask about muscle pain; CK if symptoms.
- Monitor INR with warfarin.
- Watch for right upper quadrant pain (gallstones).

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take with meals.
- Low-fat diet, limit alcohol and sugar.
- Report muscle pain, abdominal pain, yellow skin.
- Avoid sun overexposure.

KEY POINTS

- Fibrate — PPAR-α agonist; lowers triglycerides.
- Myopathy with statins; gallstones.
- Take with food.
- Raises INR; renal dose adjustment.